Answers and talk notes

Math is Boundless

What your student is learning

Tonight we design with repetition and rhythm, and we use the pattern unit — the part that repeats — to predict what comes next.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. The pattern unit of the border is 3 shapes: circle, square, triangle.
2. The same three shapes along the mural border are repetition.
3. Pink circle, purple square, blue triangle, again and again is a pattern.
4. A designer can change the size or order of shapes to give a border rhythm.
5. Because the border follows a rule, you know shape 12 before you count.

Talk about it

Who can repeat a small group of shapes in a row?

Home mission

Line up forks, spoons, and cups in a repeating row: fork, spoon, cup. Ask your student to name the pattern unit. Which item will be number 9? Then count to check.

When they are stuck, ask

- Which part repeats?
- How many items are in one repeat?
- What does the remainder tell you?

Try not to say

- Just keep drawing until you get to that number.
- Patterns are just decoration.
- The remainder does not matter.